

08 Stale Task Detector

Work rarely fails loudly. It sits still until someone notices weeks later. This notices on day three.

01 Scan daily

Every open item across the project and ticketing tools

02 Measure movement

Days since last activity, against expected cycle time for that task type

03 Diagnose the cause

Blocked, forgotten, underscoped, or legitimately waiting on someone outside

04 Act by cause

Different stalls need different responses

Blocked	→	Blocker surfaced to whoever owns it
Forgotten	→	Owner nudged directly
Too large	→	Suggests splitting it
Waiting externally	→	Follow-up date set

05 Nudge the owner first

Direct message with the task and how long it has sat

06 Summarise weekly

One digest to the team lead, not an alert per task

Nudges the owner first. The manager sees a weekly summary, not every alert.

PRIMARY PAYOFF Work stops quietly dying in the backlog.